

Bourns strives for a commitment to excellence with product innovations, delivering the highest quality and providing outstanding value for our customers.

EFY had an exclusive chat with Bourns to discuss their thriving presence in India. Discover the vital role played by their local team and distribution partners, and gain valuable insights into their strategies for market penetration and product innovation.



JAMES HARRINGTON
Senior Worldwide Sales VP

How's business in India post-covid?

A: The company's revenue and profits are both excellent due to substantial demand for Bourns' products and solutions. In fact, our business in India grew 23% in the last two years after Covid. This is in part because the management team took steps to maintain quality and its commitments to customers even in light of material shortages and logistics challenges.

How's Bourns doing business in India? Do you have an office and a team here or only through distributors?

A: We are grateful to Bourns' local distribution partners that they have helped us build such a strong business in India. In addition, we have a local team of knowledgeable technical and sales employees that support our OEM customers and distributors.

Any changes in business strategy post covid, for India?

A: We expanded the number of employees that supply local support, and will add more resources in next few years. We believe local presence is key to the success in India market. And, the culture at Bourns strives for a commitment to excellence with product innovations, delivering the highest quality and providing outstanding value for our customers.

Could you please elaborate on the strategies that the company has employed to effectively penetrate and expand its presence in the Indian market?

A: Bourns has been effective in leveraging our local channel relationships to capture strategic market segment design wins. Our combined technology and application expertise has enabled us to offer targeted solutions that meet the strict requirements of a wide range of markets such as those for various automotive applications (traditional Automotive, EV and EV charging), as well as energy storage and power management designs. This alignment and technology know-how has helped Bourns to penetrate successfully into many high-growth Indian markets.

Would you mind sharing some concrete instances of successful initiatives or deals that effectively highlight the company's impact and capabilities within the India market?

A: Bourns engineers and manufacturers a wide range of automotive-grade electronics components ranging from power management, circuit protection and sensors servicing various needs of our automotive customers. By meeting regularly with these customers, we are able to provide critical real-time technical assistance and sales support. To meet product demand, we have also continued to enhance our logistical processes to provide world-class delivery support to this market. In addition, we have signed a new distributor that offers technical consultation for start-ups and also works with designers on how to select the right Bourns product for their application specifications.

What are the latest developments that you will be (or are) demonstrating at your booth?

A: We are excited to showcase Bourns' extensive capabilities in producing customized magnetics products, particularly those that meet the reliability, high efficiency and safety requirements in automotive and industrial designs. We will also highlight a variety of new products that include our Mini Breaker devices that are the industry leading overtemperature, thermal protection solutions trusted already by many personal computing companies. Bourns is expanding this line where our mini-breaker devices are designed to be used to meet battery protection needs in EV's or for overtemperature protection for automotive heaters.

Which are the key (3 to 5) market segments which are driving sales for Bourns in India?

A: Automotive market is the main driver of Bourns sales. Bourns Trimpot, trimming potentiometers have been the most popular products for the India industrial automation market. We are also seeing tremendous growth opportunities in the Indian telecom market.

Do you expect the same segments to continue to lead in the next 3 to 5 years, or hope to see some other segments take the lead?

A: We expect EV market will continue to lead in the next 5 years. There is also a lot of potential growth in the IoT market when the full penetration of 5G deployment in India will take the lead in future.

How would you rate your satisfaction for growth of India's business vis-à-vis your expectations?

A: We are very pleased with the growth we have achieved in India, which has gained momentum in last 3 years. We intend to invest in more human resources in India as we believe sales will continue to grow in the years to come.

Many brands complain that India is a very "price sensitive" market. While others counter-claim that if you are able to connect with the right decision makers or influencers and explain the overall TCO/RoI—then India has no issues in going for the best. What's been your experience?

A: The above statement is verified by us. The India market, like many other geographical regions, is price sensitive. But with the right products and solutions offered to customers, we are realizing they are happy to adopt our recommendations. This is especially true when customers get a better understanding of the excellent reliability and quality of our products that can help them be more competitive and thus successful here.

How do you reach out to the electronics design (R&D and New Product Development) community in India? How do you keep them updated about latest innovations from your side—given that India is a very large nation, with at least 5 (B'lore, Delhi, Pune, Hbad, Chennai, etc) different cities/regions driving design-led consumption of electronics?

A: We have sales managers and FAE manager located in Bangalore and Pune to cover the customers in the North/West and South India. Our people are experienced and know the market and their customers well enabling them to provide immediate support to the design team. Furthermore, our distributors are able to expand our reach to customers throughout the pan-India region. ■